Q+A

"THERE'S NO 'PAN-INDIAN' FILM"

Ten years after Gangs of Wasseypur, *director, screenwriter and producer* ***Anurag Kashyap*** *will again reinvent himself on August 19 with the theatrical release of his latest film,* Dobaaraa

Q. Why did you want to direct *Dobaaraa*, a Hindi adaptation of the 2018 Spanish film *Mirage*?
Taapsee (Pannu) brought the script to me when we were shooting *Saand Ki Aankh* (2019). The Spanish film hadn't been released then; it was just a script for me. She had initially asked me to recommend a director who could direct the film with her in it. When I read it, I knew I should do it. I haven't attempted a mystery drama like this before.

Q. Did you find it easy to separate the writer part of yourself from the director while making *Dobaaraa*?
Yeah, I always focus on the job. When I'm the writer, all I do is write. When I am the director, I do nothing but that. And if I'm editing, that's all I care about.

Q. You've been directing films for over two decades. Are there some parts of it that have got easier over the years?
I'm as afraid of myself when I'm making a film. I feel that's the only way you can make a film. Directors who are confident of making a good film rarely make one. But over the years, I've realised one thing as a filmmaker—I need to surround myself with young people who are hungry, and then, I need to just listen to their instincts.

Q. If you had one piece of advice for new filmmakers, would you tell them to make films with a pan-Indian appeal or imagine a universe that is hyperlocal?
I would ask them to make a film that no one can make but them. There is no 'pan-Indian' film. Every successful director, whether it is Rohit Shetty, S.S. Rajamouli, or Rajkumar Hirani, finds success because they make the film they want to. Their films are pan-Indian hits, but they didn't set out to make one.

—with Poulomi Das

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH